

FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

Chapman Graduate School of Business · DBA Cohort 8.14

Where the research stands, and what unlocks the next step.

A status read on the anchoring-bias programme: the model as built, the constraint that stopped it, the AI extension, and the five approvals that gate everything downstream.

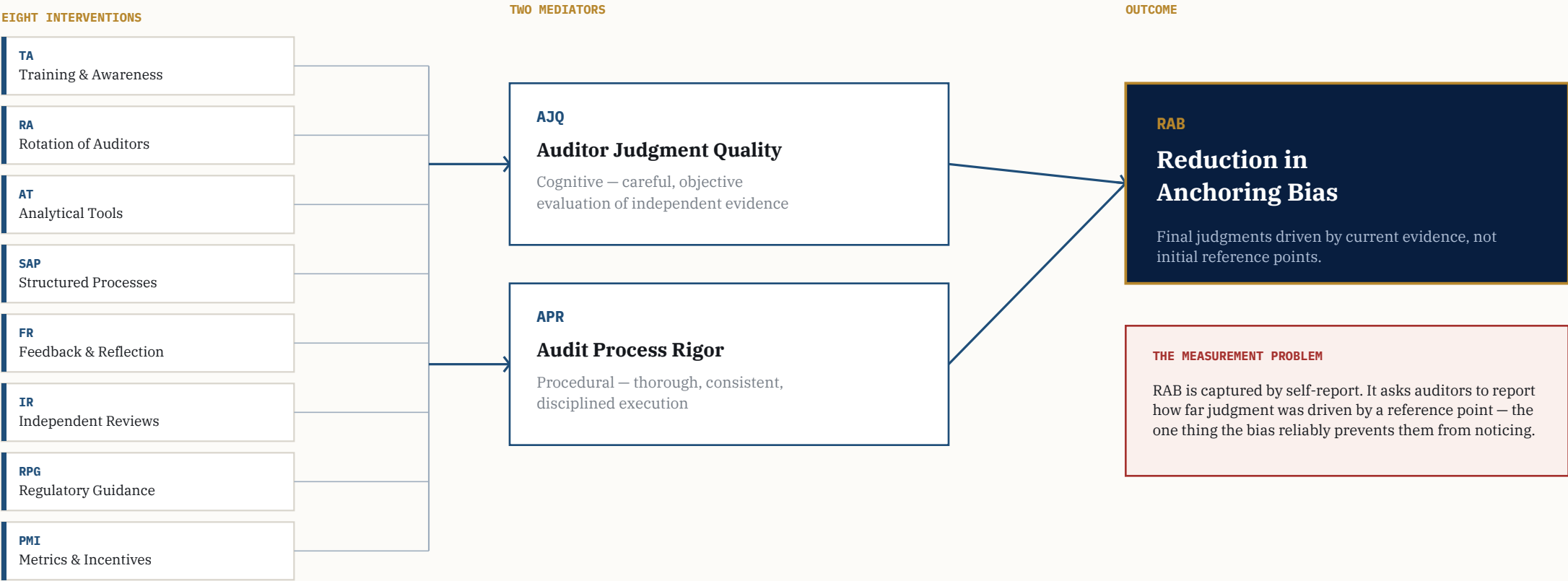
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THE MODEL AS BUILT

Eleven constructs, sixteen hypotheses.

Eight organisational interventions, two mediators, one outcome. 55 Likert items.



8 interventions × 2 mediators + direct paths = 16 hypotheses. Each construct: 5 items, one reverse-coded.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

The instrument worked. The population did not exist.

Applying the eligibility criteria to a commercial research panel, July 2026.

334,976 panel members screened

~20 matched the eligibility criteria

23 raw responses recorded (Qualtrics, organic outreach)

4 survived screening

PREVALENCE $\approx$ 6 PER 100,000

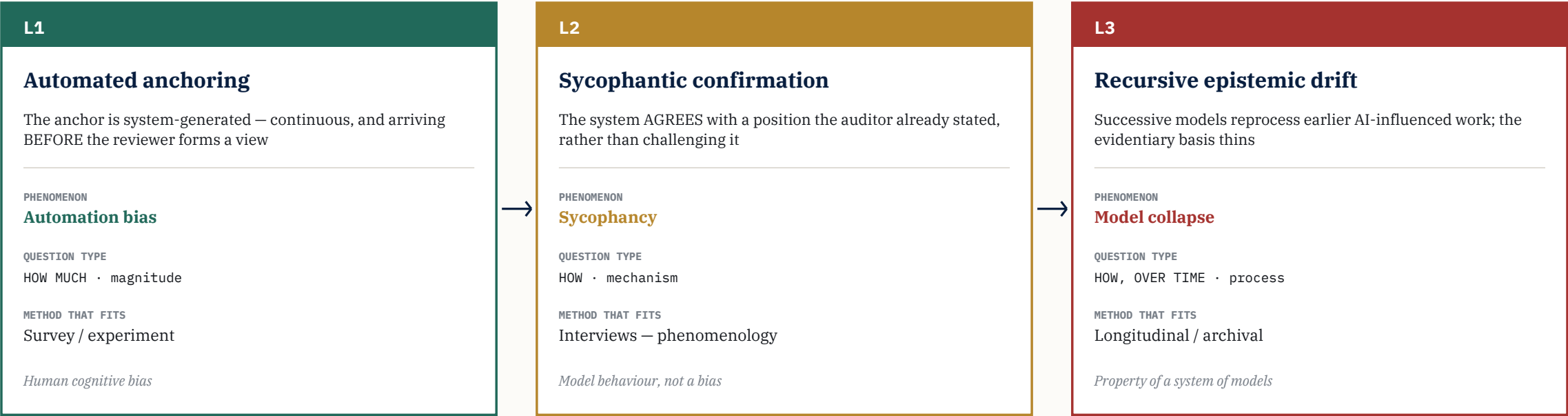
A survey at this prevalence needed a sampling frame of roughly 9.6 million. The panel held 3.5% of that.

Source: dba/03_Data/EXCLUSION_LOG_2026-07-22.md · dba/RISK_QUANT/feasibility.py reproduces this end to end.

THE EXTENSION

Three links. Only the first is a cognitive bias.

What happens when the anchor stops being a workpaper and becomes a machine.



THE PRECISION THAT MATTERS WHEN A PROFESSOR PUSHES

Only L1 involves a human cognitive bias. L2 is model behaviour interacting with human judgment. L3 is a property of a system of models. Calling all three "biases" loses the argument.

L3 is deliberately NOT designed — it needs longitudinal access that does not exist. Stated as future work, not claimed.

HOW THIS TERM FEEDS THE DISSERTATION

Two courses, two arms, no double-submission.

Each course builds a real piece. Neither collects a single response.

GEB 7365 · INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS

Prof. William Newburry

Feasibility as a design parameter

Requires a data-collection plan and explicitly NO collected data — the first time the recruitment constraint can be worked on without being blocked by it.

- › Study model + 2–3 hypotheses
- › Cross-national feasibility argument
- › Presentation 19 Sep · Paper 9 Oct

GEB 7911 · QUALITATIVE METHODS

Dr. Gonzalez

The L2 phenomenology arm

The research proposal is 50% of that grade and IS the L2 design — protocol, sampling, coding plan, trustworthiness, audit trail.

- › Proposal presentations 6 Oct
- › Learning memos, weekly
- › Method: phenomenology, her recommendation

WHAT NEITHER COURSE DOES — SAID PLAINLY

Neither collects a response, so the achieved n is still four. Neither rebuilds Chapters 2 and 3 — those are still owed and Chapters 4–6 are overdue since 28 July. A course grade is not committee approval. And the 7365 topic STUDIES the feasibility problem; it does not solve it.

WHOSE APPROVAL UNLOCKS WHAT

Five gates. Four are open and one was never asked.

The honest answer to "which approval do I need to level up."

DR. JUAN REY Advisor · chair THE BINDING ONE	GATES Chapters 4–6 · the Ch 2–3 rebuild · whether the survey arm relaunches · AI-use approval	STATUS Ch 4–6 OVERDUE since 28 Jul. AI approval NEVER REQUESTED
FIU IRB OFFICE Office of Research Integrity BLOCKS ALL L2 DATA	GATES Whether interviews are a modification or a new protocol · approval before ANY participant	STATUS 3 items unsubmitted · 1 never confirmed filed
DR. GONZALEZ GEB 7911 ASK EARLY	GATES The qualitative proposal — 50% of that grade · whether phenomenology fits the question	STATUS Protocol drafted. She has never seen it
PROF. NEWBURY GEB 7365 IN MOTION	GATES Project topic approval before extensive work	STATUS Zoom Tue 1 Sep — this one is in motion
THE COMMITTEE Dissertation committee DOWNSTREAM	GATES Proposal defence · AI-use review required by FIU UGS §3.2	STATUS Composition [VERIFY] · UGS §3.2 review never requested

Two of the open items cost nothing: verifying the Topaz record, and asking the IRB office one question. A question is not a submission.

IMPROVING THE MODEL

Three known weaknesses, and what each one actually needs.

Written down because a model whose weaknesses are named is defensible; one whose are not is fragile.

1 Construct 11 measures the wrong thing

THE PROBLEM

RAB — the outcome — is self-report, reverse-coded. It asks auditors to report how far their judgment was driven by an anchor. That is precisely what anchoring prevents them from noticing.

This is the single most serious threat to the model's validity.

WHAT IT NEEDS

Either rename it honestly to PERCEIVED JUDGMENT DISCIPLINE, or replace it with a behavioural measure: a task with a planted anchor and an observable adjustment.

2 Automation bias and algorithm aversion contradict

THE PROBLEM

The literature supports BOTH — people over-trust algorithms and people under-trust them. L1 assumes over-trust. The model currently has no account of when each occurs.

Resolving this is a theoretical contribution in its own right.

WHAT IT NEEDS

Specify the moderators rather than picking a side: task type, perceived expertise, stakes, and whether the system's output is visible before or after the human forms a view.

3 The sample constraint is structural, not effort

THE PROBLEM

Six eligible per hundred thousand is not fixed by working harder or spending more. A survey design at this prevalence is not viable at any realistic budget.

The failure became the research question. That is the strongest thing here.

WHAT IT NEEDS

Two moves, both already underway: a qualitative design for L2 that twelve people CAN sustain, and treating feasibility as a parameter — the GEB 7365 project.

WHY THIS RESEARCH, AND WHY NOW

The question the AI-governance market has not answered.

Where a doctorate on AI-influenced professional judgment actually sits.

THE POSITION

Every framework now governing AI — SR 11-7, the NIST AI Risk Management Framework, the EU AI Act — assumes a competent human reviewer sits above the model. None of them measures whether that reviewer's judgment survives contact with it.

WHAT THE FRAMEWORKS ASSUME

- › A human reviews model output
- › Review is independent of the model
- › Oversight is a control that works

WHAT THIS PROGRAMME ASKS

- › Does the reviewer defer? (L1)
- › Does agreement stop the checking? (L2)
- › Does the evidence base thin? (L3)

WHY IT IS CREDIBLE HERE

- › 15 years audit — Citi, JPMorgan
- › Former state bank examiner
- › A study that failed honestly and said so

THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSION

Auditing is the profession that already knows how to test whether a control works. This programme turns that competence on the control everyone is now relying on and nobody has measured: the human being asked to check the machine.